Skills Summary

Using Twos, Fives, and Tens as Anchor Facts

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Three facts you can always count, and never have to memorise.

- **twos** — every other number: 2, 4, 6, 8, ...
- **fives** — the nickel count: 5, 10, 15, 20, ...
- **tens** — the number with a zero after it: 10, 20, 30, ...

Every other fact is one small step away from one of these three. Find the nearest anchor, take the step, and the fact is yours.

1. Double a two-fact to get a four-fact

4 is two 2s, so six groups of 4 is six groups of 2 counted *twice*. Count by twos to get the two-fact, then double the answer. The same move takes a four-fact to an eight-fact.

Example: Find 9×4.
Step 1. Nine fours is hard to count, but nine twos is not — so start at the two-fact and double it.
Step 2. $9 \times 2 = 18$, and doubling gives $18 + 18$.

$$9 \times 4 = \mathbf{36}$$

Try it: Use the two-fact 8×2 to find 8×4.

check: **32**

2. Take one group off a ten-fact to get a nine-fact

9 is one less than 10, so a nine-fact is the ten-fact minus **one whole group**. Write the ten-fact first, then subtract the group size — not 1.

Example: Find 6×9.
Step 1. Nine groups is one group short of ten groups, so start high at the ten-anchor and remove a group.
Step 2. $6 \times 10 = 60$, and one group is worth 6, so take 6 away.

$$6 \times 9 = \mathbf{54}$$

Try it: Use the ten-fact 4×10 to find 4×9.

check: **36**

3. Add one more group to a five-fact

A six-fact is the five-fact plus **one more group**. A seven-fact is the five-fact plus **two more groups** — which is the same as the five-fact plus the two-fact, because $5 + 2 = 7$.

Example: Find 7×6.
Step 1. Six groups is one group past the five-anchor, so build up from the five-fact instead of counting sixes.
Step 2. $7 \times 5 = 35$, and one more group of 7 is $35 + 7$.

$$7 \times 6 = \mathbf{42}$$

Try it: Use the five-fact 6×5 to find 6×6.

check: **36**

4. Divide by counting up on an anchor

Division asks **how many jumps** of one size fill the total. On a two, five, or ten anchor you can simply count up and keep score with your fingers — the number of jumps is the answer.

Example: Find $35 \div 5$.
Step 1. Counting up on the five-anchor is easier than sharing 35 out one at a time, so count fives and track the jumps.
Step 2. 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35 — that is 7 jumps, so $5 \times 7 = 35$.

$$35 \div 5 = \mathbf{7}$$

Try it: How many jumps of 10 make 80? Write the division fact.

check: **8**

(!) Watch out: the step from an anchor is always a whole *group*, never a single counter — 7×9 is $70 - 7$, not $70 - 1$. And say which anchor you used out loud; an answer with no anchor behind it is a guess.